

Case Study : UPI /Online Payment Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes in India, where attackers trick users into authorizing fraudulent transactions. This type of fraud usually occurs through social engineering rather than technical hacking.

A typical case begins when the victim receives a call, SMS, or WhatsApp message from a scammer pretending to be a bank official, delivery agent, or customer support executive. The scammer creates urgency by claiming an issue such as a failed transaction, KYC update, or refund. The victim is then asked to click on a malicious link or approve a payment request sent via a UPI app. In some cases, scammers also use screen-sharing apps to gain access to the victim's device.

Once the victim enters their UPI PIN or approves the request, money is instantly transferred to the scammer's account. Since UPI transactions are real-time, recovering the money becomes extremely difficult.

Students and young users are often targeted due to their frequent use of digital payments and lack of awareness about such scams. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and potential misuse of personal data. This highlights the importance of awareness and cautious behavior while using digital payment systems.